

Thiraj (Chamika) Hettiarachchi

thiraj.hettiarachchi@gmail.com | +94 70 642 8000 | linkedin.com/in/thiraj | Kalutara, Sri Lanka | Open to Remote & Hybrid Roles

Full Stack Engineer • PHP / Laravel / React • API & E-commerce Specialist

PROFILE

Full stack engineer with 6+ years in software development, including three years building and running large-scale e-commerce platforms in production. Specialises in REST API development, payment gateway integrations, and Docker-based deployments, with earlier hands-on experience across WordPress and other major CMS platforms. Active user of modern AI tooling including Claude Code, MCP servers, and LLM-assisted development pipelines.

EXPERIENCE

Software Engineer • Fexcon (Pvt) Ltd, Nawala, Sri Lanka *Jun 2023 – Present*

- Develop and maintain multiple e-commerce platforms in Laravel, Zend Framework, and React, including performance work that cut page load times by 40% across 15 production websites
- Engineered RESTful APIs in PHP and Python supporting up to \$2M in monthly transaction volume
- Integrated payment gateways (Stripe, Paypal, PayHere, Koko, Mintpay) end to end — webhook flows, checkout pipelines, and reconciliation logic
- Containerised deployments with Docker across 100+ software components for consistent multi-environment releases
- Built a cron-based automation framework that now handles transactional email and SMS notifications across all company platforms
- Manage AWS infrastructure (S3 media storage, EC2 deployments) for Laravel and WordPress projects

Associate Software Engineer • WebTechno, Kalutara, Sri Lanka (Remote) *Nov 2019 – Jun 2023*

- Delivered 15+ client projects end to end, from requirements gathering through launch and ongoing support
- Developed custom themes and plugins across WordPress, Shopify, Wix, Squarespace, and GoDaddy for international clients
- Revamped a US-based sports nutrition brand's website, driving a 150% increase in organic traffic within six months through SEO and performance optimisation
- Integrated third-party REST and GraphQL APIs to connect client platforms with external services and streamline business workflows

IT Support Assistant • Madinat Jumeirah, Dubai, UAE *Jan 2016 – Nov 2019*

- Supported IT infrastructure for a luxury resort serving 500+ guests and staff, keeping the network running through peak seasons
- Configured and rolled out POS systems for three new restaurant openings
- Implemented cybersecurity hardening measures that measurably reduced IT security incidents

SKILLS

Languages: PHP, Python, JavaScript

Frameworks: Laravel, Zend Framework, React.js

APIs & Integration: REST, GraphQL, Payment Gateways (PayHere, Koko, Mintpay), Webhooks

CMS Platforms: WordPress, Shopify, Wix, Squarespace, GoDaddy — custom theme & plugin development

DevOps & Cloud: Docker, AWS (S3, EC2), Nginx, Linux, Cloudflare, UFW

Databases: MySQL, Query Optimisation

AI Tooling: Claude Code, MCP Servers, LLM Integrations, AI-assisted Pipelines

Tools: Git, Bitbucket, Jira, VS Code, Postman

EDUCATION

BEng (Hons) in Software Engineering (Top-up) • London Metropolitan University *Feb 2023 – Aug 2024*

BTEC Higher National Diploma in Computing • ESOF Metro Campus *Feb 2021 – Oct 2022*

PERSONAL PROJECTS

Biometric Attendance System • IoT / Hardware

- Employee attendance system: ESP32 + FPM10A fingerprint sensor driven by a full state machine, with OLED display, 4x4 keypad, and admin PIN protection; Node.js/Express backend with SQLite